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Rose

Two days later, Rose stood alongside Léa, waiting as Weinführer Brucker inspected the vats and the barrels to confirm the quality of the fuel. When he was satisfied all was in order, he instructed Monsieur Ferney to help the sisters wheel the barrels to the truck parked outside, where he lifted them onto the truck bed with the driver's help.

Returning inside to fetch another barrel, Rose noticed the Weinführer walking around the *chai*. She saw mud on the floor near the carpet, and smoothed her hand over her apron to stop it from shaking. They'd spent the last two nights bringing the rail cars inside, cleaning them out and hauling them into the cave. Then they'd swept out the *chai* so that there would be no trace of what they'd been doing—but clearly, they'd missed a spot. Would he notice? The Weinführer tapped his boots on the carpet, as if testing what was underneath. She held her breath, waiting, but he seemed satisfied and left.

That night, the sisters set out when the church bell rang at midnight. A full moon shone. At least it would make it easier for them to find their way to the jetty where the smuggler's boat would be waiting, but it might also make them more visible to passing patrols. Rose had an uneasy feeling. She wished André was here.

"That's it. We're done. Are you ready?" Léa asked after they finished loading the last of the wine into the tunnel.

"We could wait a few more days," Rose suggested, shuffling her feet. Maybe it was just the sense of being underground that gnawed at her. Moving away from the tunnel, she recalled how the Weinführer had tapped his boots on the carpet—did he know? "What if he's figured out what we're